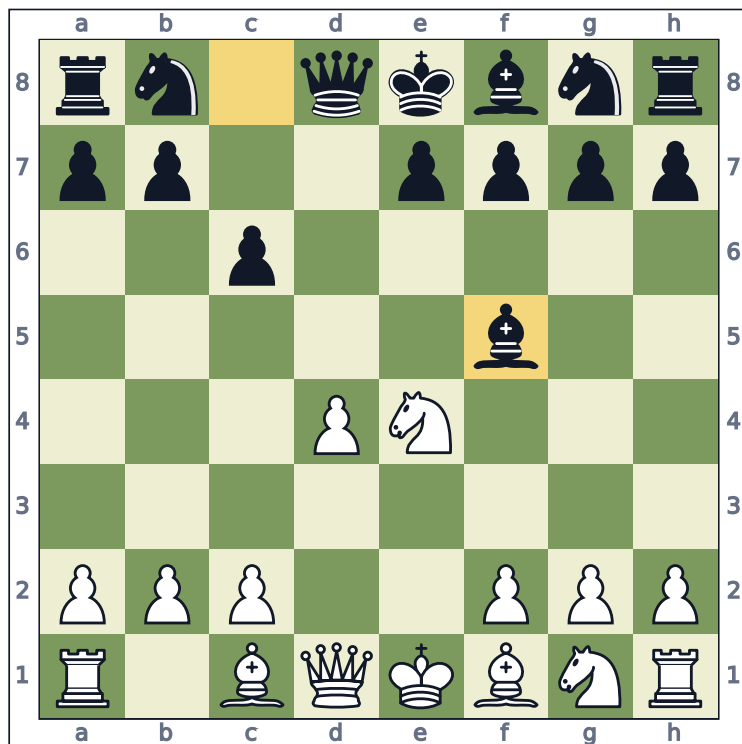


CARO-KANN DEFENSE

Caro-Kann Defense

ECO B18 | 5 named lines in this code



Featured opening position - gold marks the last move

IS IT A GOOD OPENING?

Good and fully playable. The position remains within a normal opening balance for both sides.

ENGINE SNAPSHOT

+0.42 for White. A shallow opening score is a guide, not a forced result.

GAME CHARACTER

Principled and instructive: development and central breaks lead naturally into the middlegame.

WHAT THIS OPENING IS

B18 covers Caro-Kann Defense. Black supports ...d5 with ...c6, aiming for a sound center and a useful light-squared bishop. The diagram uses the featured line Caro-Kann Defense: Classical Variation.

DEFINING ROUTE

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. Nd2 dxe4 4. Nxe4 Bf5

UNDERSTAND THE POSITION

What both sides are trying to achieve

WHITE'S GOALS

Use space and development, decide whether to advance or exchange on d5, and prevent Black's freeing breaks from coming easily.

BLACK'S GOALS

Develop the c8 bishop before closing it in, complete the structure, and seek ...c5 or ...e5 at the right moment.

PAWN BREAKS - THE ENGINE OF THE OPENING

Black's freeing breaks are ...c5 and ...e5; White may use c4, f4-f5, or a timely e6 push in advanced structures.

PIECE MAP

Black's light bishop is a strategic asset. White's knights often aim at e5, f5, and c5. The central pawn placement should decide where each bishop and knight belongs.

WHAT USUALLY GOES WRONG

Black can become passive by defending the structure without arranging a freeing break. Recheck the center after every opponent deviation; opening names do not make moves automatic.

POSITION SNAPSHOT

White moves next. Material is level. Central markers: Black pawn on c6, White pawn on d4.

WHO SHOULD STUDY IT?

One of the best sound defenses to 1.e4, especially for players who value structure and endgame quality.

COMPLETE CODE CONTENTS

Every named B18 line

This section preserves all 5 names and defining routes assigned to B18 in the source catalogue. Different move orders can reach the same position; learn the structures and goals before memorizing labels.

001 Caro-Kann Defense: Classical Variation

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. Nd2 dxe4 4. Nxe4 Bf5

002 Caro-Kann Defense: Classical Variation, Flohr Variation

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. Nd2 dxe4 4. Nxe4 Bf5 5. Ng3 Bg6 6. Nh3

003 Caro-Kann Defense: Classical Variation, Main Line

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. Nd2 dxe4 4. Nxe4 Bf5 5. Ng3 Bg6 6. h4

004 Caro-Kann Defense: Classical Variation, Maróczy Attack

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. Nd2 dxe4 4. Nxe4 Bf5 5. Ng3 Bg6 6. f4

005 Caro-Kann Defense: Martian Gambit

1. e4 c6 2. d4 d5 3. Nd2 dxe4 4. Nxe4 Bf5 5. Ng5 Bg6 6. N1f3 h6 7. Ne6